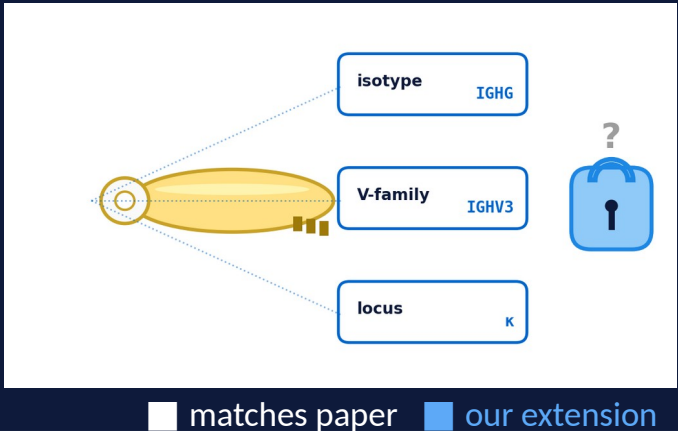


Multi-Condition Latent Diffusion for Paired Antibody Sequences

Sampling controls the novelty–foldability trade-off in multi-condition antibody diffusion.

Yunqi Li · Yonglin Zhang · Cornell University · CS 4782 Spring 2026



§1 Why antibody generation is hard

Need: valid, diverse, non-memorized paired sequences.

Design brief = 3 biological conditions:

- isotype → key handle
- V-gene family → main groove
- light-chain locus → side notch

Question: can continuous (LD4LG) and discrete (DPLM) diffusion produce useful variation under the same brief?

§2 Running example: IGHG · IGHV3 · κ

We trace one antibody-key from brief → generated sequence → folded structure. The same example reappears in §3 and §4.

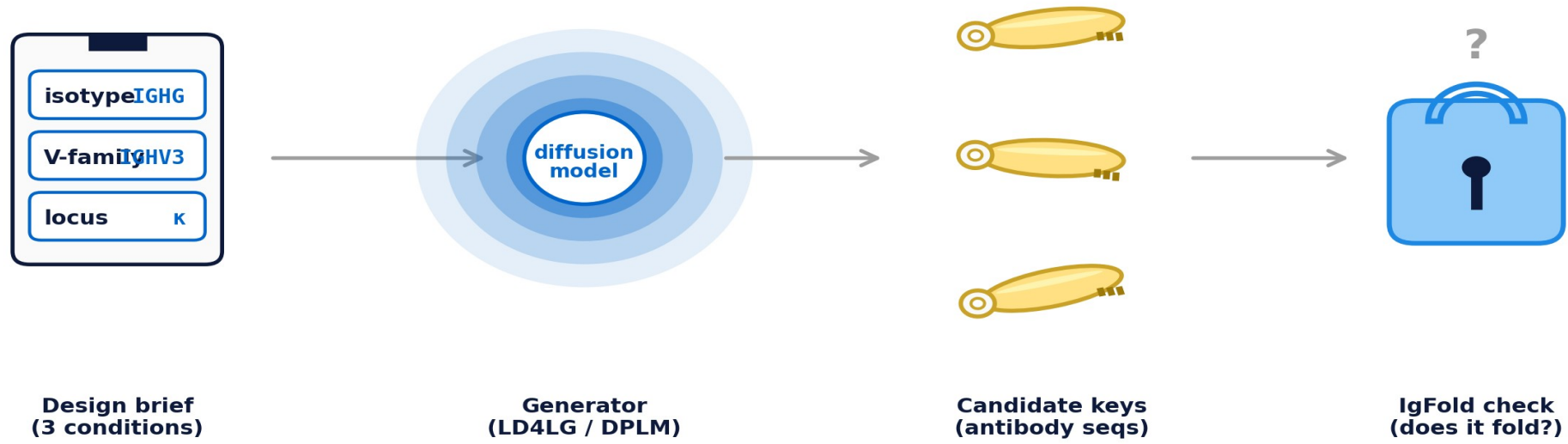


Fig 1. Design brief → diffusion generator → candidate antibody-keys → IgFold check.

§2.1 Why this matters (ML framing)

Token-space Gaussian diffusion (Diffusion-LM) gets MAUVE 0.04 — discrete-noise mismatch. **LD4LG** pushes that boundary into a continuous latent (MAUVE 0.72). **DPLM** instead avoids it via absorbing-state mask noise. We compare both, on the same data.

§3 Two diffusion paradigms, one task

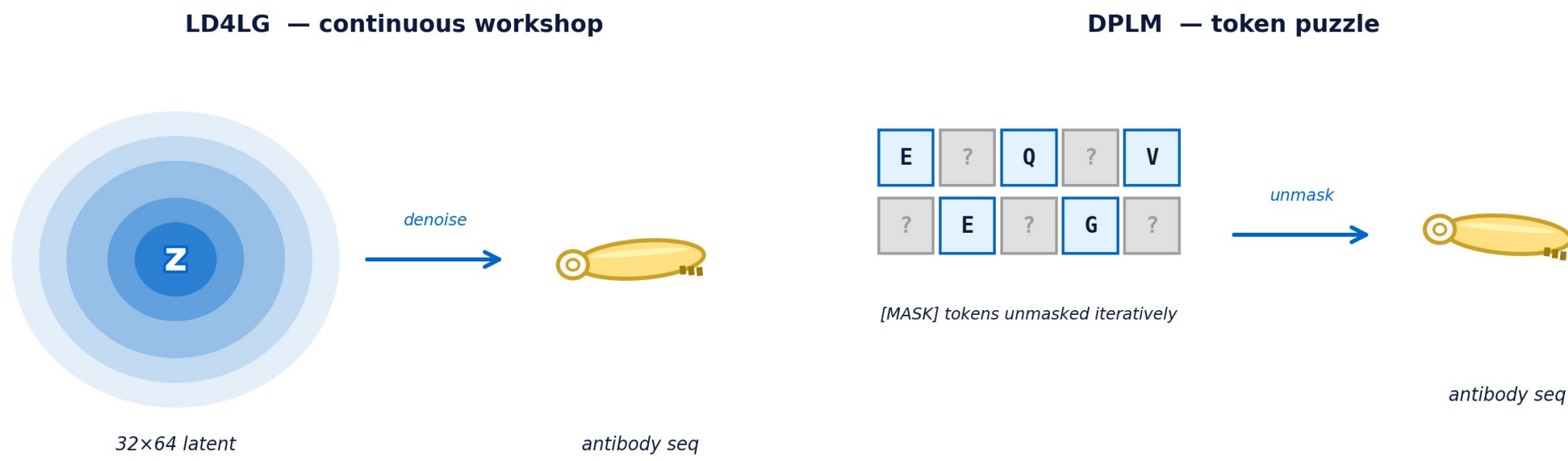


Fig 2. LD4LG denoises a continuous latent. DPLM unmaskes tokens iteratively.

LD4LG (continuous workshop)

- Encoder → 32×64 latent
- Cosine schedule + v-pred loss
- 12-layer denoiser w/ AdaLN(t,c)
- 250-step DDPM
- AR decoder → AA tokens

DPLM (token puzzle)

- 1-stage bidirectional Transformer
- Mask schedule $\gamma(t)$
- CE loss on masked positions
- 100-step iterative unmask
- **top-p stochastic fix** (our extension)

§4 The sampling fix (our extension)

Greedy argmax → same key, every time



✗ 4-gram diversity = 0.002 (mode collapse)

Stochastic top-p (T=1.3) → varied keys



✓ 4-gram diversity = 0.379 (6x recovery)

Fig 3. Greedy keeps minting the same key; top-p sampling unlocks variation. 20-config sweep on top of this.

§5 Three findings

✓ **Reproduction works**

100% validity · **0%** memorize · **100%** V-gene fid

✗ **Greedy DPLM collapsed**

4-gram diversity = **0.002** all keys nearly identical

🔍 **Diversity has a cost** (our key finding)

div **0.067** → **0.379** (×6 ↑)

foldable share **97%** → **26%** (intrinsic, not a bug)

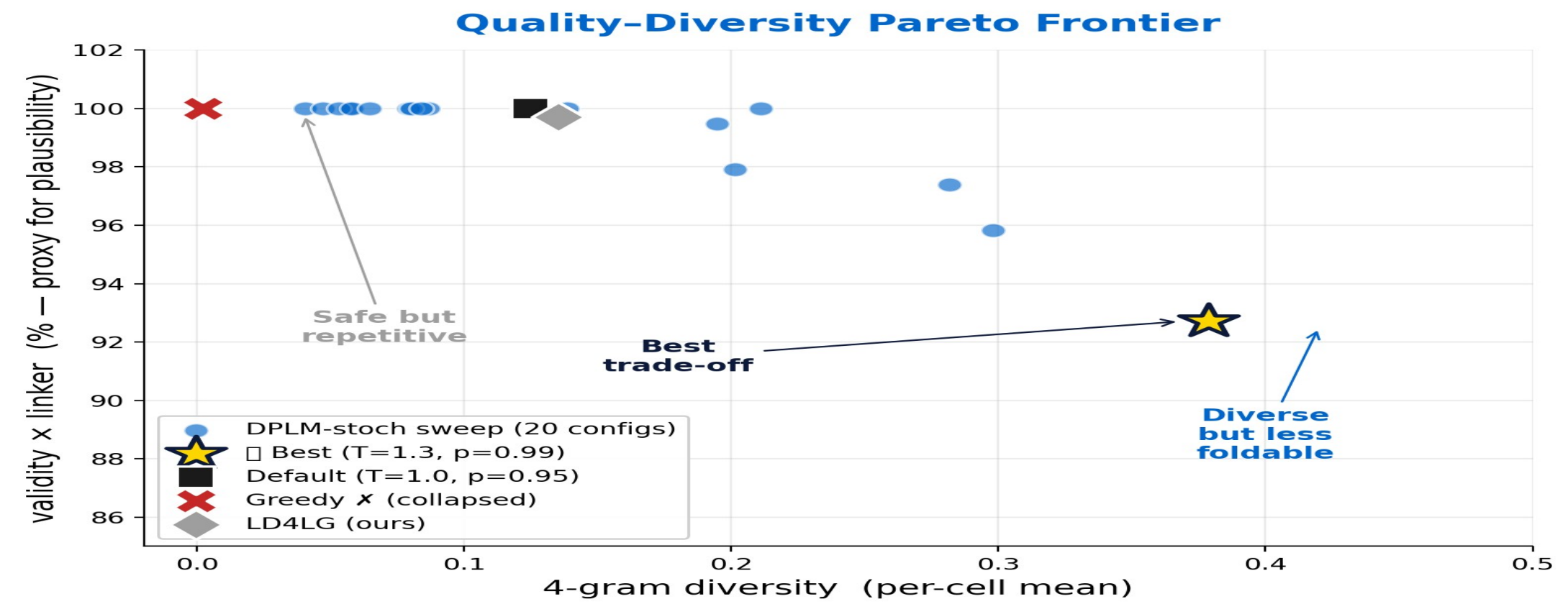


Fig 4. Pareto frontier — each marker is one sweep config. Novelty starts costing structural plausibility around T=1.15.

Sweep: mean 4-gram diversity (3 cells × 64 seqs)



Fig 5. Sampling is a control knob, not an implementation detail.

Diffusion model choice matters, but **sampling strategy** decides whether the model produces clones, useful variants, or biologically risky sequences.

Greedy → mode collapse

DDP self-cond → rank divergence

More diversity → less foldability

Future: antigen-conditional · structure-aware diffusion · active selection on Pareto